CHAPTER 08 · CASE STUDIES

Same model, different system

08

An industrial company introduced AI demand forecasting. The forecast improved within weeks — and the business did not move. The book presents it as a composite of several organisations.

BEFORE · MONTH 0–6

AI forecast
Improves within weeks

Procurement
Keeps its own safety logic

Production
Plans on last year's pattern

Sales
Promises dates from a private spreadsheet

No owner for the chain, no shared data, no agent boundaries.

AFTER · ONE WORKFLOW REDESIGNED

AI forecast
The model is unchanged

Forecast → purchase order
One owner end to end

Shared data
One forecast every function uses

Explicit agent boundaries
What the model decides, what it recommends

Adoption up | Safety stock down

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- ✓ The AI did not fail; the condition it entered was not an operating condition.
- ✓ One workflow, one owner, shared data and boundaries changed the outcome.
- ✓ The investment appeared in the numbers only after the redesign.